

Noach 5784 (2)

In פרשת נח, after the extraordinary מפש מסירות of serving everyone in the תיבה, it was a devastating experience to come out to a world which had nothing. We know that נח was a צדיק, but for whatever reason (9:20) וַיִּקַּח נֹחַ אִישׁ הָאֶדְמָה וַיֵּטַע כֶּרֶם, and became שיכור and הם came and saw what happened and told his two brothers. A famous pasuk (9:23): וַיִּקַּח נֹחַ וַיִּבְרָא אֶת הַשְּׂמֵלָה וַיְשִׂימוּ עַל שָׂקָם שְׁנֵיהֶם וַיֵּלְכוּ אַחֲרָיו וַיַּכְסּוּ אֹתוֹ. The מצוה brings a מדרש that says that נֹחַ and יִבְרָא got a שכר for doing this מצוה of אב כיבוד.

נֹחַ's שכר is after the מלחמת גוג ומגוג when they die, his offspring will be זוכה to קבורה. What will נֹחַ get? נֹחַ will get clothing with which one can do the מצוה of ציצית. What's the difference between the two of them? The answer is in the pasuk: וַיִּקַּח נֹחַ אֶת הַשְּׂמֵלָה. That's a grammatically incorrect phrase. The Torah is specifically saying, "And he took," and it's talking about two people, it should say ויקחו. The מדרש says נֹחַ took it as a מצוה לעבדוּת. However, יִבְרָא only tagged along, he shlepped along to do it, but he did it without any טעם, without any חיות, without any great enthusiasm. So one did a מצוה לעבדוּת, and one did a מצוה טעם. So guess what, the שכר is equally compensatory. It's מדה כנגד מדה. נֹחַ did it with a ברען, as a living מצוה, therefore he gets a living שכר. But יִבְרָא, you did a מצוה טעם, you get a שכר that after you die, you're going to get buried, which is also a זכות, but not comparable to נֹחַ's שכר.

If you do a מצוה, do it with your whole heart. Do it the way that נֹחַ did it. That's the way to do a מצוה.